

Tea Cover & Matching Mat

HAND-PIECED PATCHWORK · A NAMED SET

✓ **THE MAT IS MEASURED AND CONFIRMED** (2026-09-29) — everything in the left column is real. **The cover is 12" × 9"**, which is published. What is still read off photographs is only the **inside** of the cover, and it sits in the boxes bottom right. ❌ **The provisional sheet said the mat was bound in cream. It is not bound at all** — corrected.

The mat CONFIRMED

12" × 12" 9 5" ½" none

FINISHED SQUARES · 3 × 3 CUT SIZE OF EACH SEAM THROUGHOUT BINDING · TURNED INSTEAD

🧵 **CONFIRM THE ½" ONCE.** It is the only seam that lands on 12", so it is almost certainly right: **3 × 5" = 15"**, less two ½" seams = a **13" panel**, less ½" all round when it is turned = **12"**. A ¼" quilting seam would have finished at 13½". 🧵 The scrunchie pattern uses ½" too, so this is consistent with how you sew.

Cut list ONE MAT

PIECE	CUT	NOTES
Front squares	9 × 5" × 5"	Mixed prints. Lay all nine out before sewing any.
Backing	13" × 13"	One piece. Cut it <i>after</i> the front, to the front's real size.
Heat-resistant batting	13" × 13"	Insul-Bright or Insul-Fleece. Trim to 12" to keep the bulk out of the seam.
Turning gap	about 3"	Along one side, never a corner.

Order of work THE MAT

- Lay out the nine 3 × 3 and look at it. Move apart any print that repeats on a diagonal — this is the whole design decision and it takes a minute.
- Sew into three rows of three, ½" seams. Press each row's seams the opposite way to the row above so the joins nest.
- Join the three rows. The panel measures 13" × 13". If it doesn't, cut the backing to whatever it actually is.
- Add the heat-resistant batting behind the pieced front. **Fusible (Insul-Fleece):** press it on from the fabric side, with a cloth and a moderate iron. **Not fusible (Insul-Bright):** baste it round the edge inside the seam allowance, or quilt through the patch seams.
- Front and backing right sides together. Sew all round at ½", leaving the 3" gap. Clip the four corners on the diagonal.
- Turn, poke the corners out, press hard. Turn the gap's raw edges in as you press so they sit level with the seam.
- Topstitch all round close to the edge — it closes the gap and it is what makes the edge crisp instead of puffy.

🧵 **Calculated, not measured:** a fat quarter yields **12 squares** at 5" — one mat and three spare. 🧵 **Nine 5" squares is what scraps are for**, and 5" is charm-pack size, so a charm pack is a mat with change.

✓ **IT IS A TRIVET, NOT A PLACEMAT — SAY SO.** The middle layer is **heat-resistant batting** (Insul-Bright or Insul-Fleece), not plain interfacing, so it **genuinely protects the table from a hot pot**. That is a listing line, it is a real material cost, and it is **half the argument for clearing the \$40 floor**. A decorative mat and a trivet are not the same product.

⚠️ **IT IS A SUPPLY YOU HAVE TO HAVE BOUGHT.** Heat-resistant batting is not something the cupboard produces by accident — like the 2" bow clips, **running out stops the job with fabric to spare**. Keep a yard in. **Check whether yours is the fusible kind.** *Insul-Fleece* is iron-on; *Insul-Bright* is not — that one is basted or quilted in, not fused. **Press it with a cloth and a moderate iron:** there is a reflective film in there and a hot plate straight on it will distort it.

The cover STILL OPEN

WHAT	KNOWN	WRITE IT IN
Width × height	12" × 9"	
Patch grid, face	—	
Same 5" squares?	—	
Layers inside	—	
Hem binding width	—	

Layers inside the cover is the one that matters — it decides whether it keeps a pot warm.

Selling it

SELL IT AS A NAMED SET, not two pieces. The ready-made cover was **\$35**; the mat was invoiced at **\$35**, which sits **under the published \$40 home-pieces floor**. Done once, fine — **not again**. Price the next matching piece at **\$40**, or price the pair as one set. 🧵 **The heat-resistant batting is what makes \$40 easy to say out loud** — it is a bought material doing a real job, not a mark-up. ❌ **No band on this sheet on purpose** — the custom bands live in eight places and all eight change together.

Fabric: five prints off the Tea with the Suriel shelf — the best argument that collection has. 🧵 Always shoot a cosy ON the pot.